

josegudemd.com

Notes on how to improve the site, and how to publicize it once it is ready

Framing

The site's biggest strength is also its biggest discoverability problem: it is *deep*. 108 EN essay pages, ~36 curated video clips of named scientists and philosophers, 43 audio narrations of essays, full EN/ES parity throughout most of the site, and a 13-section Synthesis essay tying it all together. That depth is rare in this space and is the actual point. But a stranger arriving cold has no clear path through it. The notes below separate two distinct problems — how to improve the site so that a first-time visitor stays, and how to publicize it so that the right kind of first-time visitor arrives.

Part 1 — How to improve the site

1. A clearer first three minutes

The single highest-leverage improvement is probably a stronger landing experience. [start-here.html](#) already exists, but consider replacing the front-page hero with a 60-second author-narrated video: you, in your office or on a walk, saying *here is what this site is, here is why I built it, here is the one essay to read if you only read one*. The voice carries authority that prose alone does not, and you already have the audio experience from the 43 narrations. People decide whether to stay in seconds; let your voice do that work.

2. A positioning sentence on every page

Right now the Field Trilogy framing is implicit. A one-line tagline near the top of every essay — something like «*by José Gude MD — clinical voice, three centuries of philosophical lineage, contemporary consciousness science*» — would orient the second-time visitor who landed on [morphic-resonance.html](#) from a Google search. It is not branding for branding's sake; it is so a confused reader can decide «is this a site I want to be on» in two seconds.

3. Trust signals

Photograph of you on About. Credentials front-and-center. The clinical-voice essays (*A Clinical Life, Death and Dying*) are the most powerful trust generators on the site; they should be linked higher on the front page because they make a stranger feel «this is a real physician with real bedside experience, not someone with a website.» Right now they sit a layer deep.

4. Transcripts on the audio essays

You have audio narration but no text-companion transcripts on the audio pages. Whisper'd transcripts (even rough first-pass) would help accessibility, search-engine indexing, and the reader who wants to grep something they heard you say. Easy win.

5. The books → site → books loop

Right now the site reads as though the trilogy already exists as something a reader can buy. If it does — Amazon, Kindle, audiobook, independent bookstores — the purchase path needs to be one click from the front page and one click from every essay's footer. If the books are not yet out, the equivalent is «coming [date], sign up to be notified». The site is doing enormous work on a reader's behalf; capture the converted readers.

6. Email capture

One simple field — «*essays I publish later, sent to you, no other use*» — built on a Substack or Mailchimp. Right now an engaged reader leaves and never returns; you have no way to bring them back. Substack would also let you republish select essays there as a serial, which is the next thing.

7. Technical housekeeping

Confirm mobile rendering on a real phone — the essays are long-form and need to read well on a 6-inch screen. Make sure each page has a clean meta description (you have OG images, but meta descriptions are also indexed and clicked). Submit your sitemap to Google Search Console if you have not. Consider a sitemap.xml in addition to the human-readable sitemap.html for search engines. Performance check on the audio-heavy pages: preload="none" is already set on the audio elements, which is the right default, but worth verifying nothing else is hitting the audio bandwidth on initial load.

Part 2 — How to publicize the site

The thing most worth understanding is that the site has a *non-standard* audience and they cluster in identifiable places. The channels below are rough-prioritized.

1. Essentia Foundation

Bernardo Kastrup's outlet. The site cites Kastrup repeatedly and the structural alignment is real. A guest essay submission, even one that summarizes one of the existing pages (*The Idealist Tradition, Physics and Consciousness as Fundamental, D'Ariano-Faggin*) would put you in front of exactly the right ~80,000 readers. The Faggin-D'Ariano material is the other Essentia-natural angle.

2. The podcast tour

Curt Jaimungal's *Theories of Everything* covers exactly this material and is reachable. *After Skool* animates this kind of content. Smaller but real: Bernardo Kastrup's own podcast, Iain McGilchrist's outlets, Mark Guber (*An End to Upside Down Thinking*), *Closer to Truth's* long-running interviews. Pitch with the clinical-voice angle — physicians who write at this depth on consciousness are rare, and that is your hook.

3. The Spanish-language audience

Hugely underserved in this space. The Hispanic philosophy and consciousness community on YouTube and Substack is small but loyal, and full Spanish parity is itself a competitive advantage. *Pensamiento Contemporáneo*, *Café Filosófico*, and similar outlets. Boise has a Hispanic-press angle locally; Galicia is a regional angle too — *Diario de Galicia* and *La Voz de Galicia* would likely cover a Galician-American physician-novelist as a human-interest story, and you would reach the *Camino*-oriented Spanish reader who already cares about the Compostela material on the site.

4. Reddit

Annoying but effective if done well: r/consciousness, r/Idealism, r/PhilosophyofScience, r/AskPhilosophy. Do not post your own essays. Participate substantively in threads where they are relevant, and let your profile point to the site. r/awakened and r/spirituality are noisier but bigger.

5. Book communities

Goodreads pages for the novels, with sample chapters. A *Reading is sexy* or Bookstagram-type push if any of the trilogy is available now.

6. Scholarly citation density

Encourage academics and writers who quote the material to cite specific essay pages rather than just josegudemd.com. Add a «Cite this page» widget (BibTeX, APA) on each essay — five-minute job, big quality-of-citation improvement.

7. A real launch event

The honest constraint: most of these channels are downstream of a real launch event. A site that «has always been there quietly» does not get attention; one that «just launched» or «has a new essay just dropped» does. Pick a date. Make it a real launch — perhaps coinciding with one of the books going on sale, or with a major essay being released — and use that one moment to do coordinated outreach across all the channels above. The site is the product; the launch is the event that introduces the product to the audiences that already care about its themes.

Part 3 — What to avoid

Paid social advertising — low signal-to-noise for content this specialized. The audience that cares cannot be reached cheaply through that channel; the budget is better spent on conference registrations, podcast outreach time, or honoraria for translation help.

Wikipedia self-references — against Wikipedia's own conflict-of-interest rules and will backfire. Wait until others cite you there organically.

Broad-spectrum SEO consultants — you will get keyword optimization that does not fit the voice of the site. The kind of person who finds the site through a generic-SEO funnel is not the kind of reader who stays. Targeted outreach to the right communities will do more.

Notes from conversation, 9-10 June 2026. The site is unusual in the best way — a serious physician-novelist's twenty-year synthesis, with the clinical voice that anchors it. That is rare. The notes above are first-pass; pick the two or three that resonate, execute those well, and the rest can follow as the site grows.